

Board 1

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 5 2

♥ J 9 8

♦ 6 4

♣ K Q J 10 4

♠ A Q 6

♥ K 7 5 2

♦ A 8 7 3

♣ 7 5



♠ J 9 8 4

♥ Q 10 3

♦ K 9 2

♣ 9 6 3

♠ K 7 3

♥ A 6 4

♦ Q J 10 5

♣ A 8 2

West

North

East

South

Pass

1♥

Pass

1♦

Pass

3NT

Pass

1NT

All Pass

3NT by South

With 14 points you will naturally open the bidding. You should open a 4-card ♦ suit rather than a 3-card ♣ suit. Partner responds 1♥.

Partner might have bid a 4-card suit so you cannot support ♥s with only 3. Instead, you describe your balanced, minimum opener by bidding 1NT. Partner then bids 3NT and you pass.

South plays 3NT. West leads the ♣K.

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Winners: ♠ 3 : ♥ 2 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 1 : Total = 7

You need to find 2 more winners and they can come from the ♦ suit. You can finesse West for the ♦K. If he has it then you will get 3 extra tricks, but even if East has the ♦K you can still make 2 winners.

The problem is that if you win the first or second ♣ and then try the ♦ finesse East may win and still have a ♣ to lead back to his partner. So you should hold up the ♣A until the third round of the suit. Then if East wins the ♦K he may not have another ♣.

Imagine that you had won either the first or second ♣. When East won the ♦K he would still have had a ♣ to return to West's hand. You would have lost 4 ♣ tricks and the ♦K.

But what if East **DID** have another ♣ when he won the ♦K?

Suppose you held up until the third ♣. When East won the ♦K here he had a fourth ♣ to return to West's hand. That means the ♣ suit split 4-4 so you would have lost only 3 ♣ tricks and the ♦K.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 9 3

♥ A 5 3

♦ A K J 10 5 4

♣ 6

♠ Q 7 2

♥ K Q 8 6

♦ Q 9 2

♣ K Q 7



♠ 10

♥ 10 9 7 4 2

♦ 7 3

♣ 10 9 5 4 2

♠ A K 8 6 5 4

♥ J

♦ 8 6

♣ A J 8 3

West

North

East

South

2♦

3♦

Pass

1♠

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by South

South plays 4♠. West leads the ♦A, then ♦K, then ♦J. East discards on the second ♦ and ruffs the third one with the ♠T.

Losers: ♠ 0? : ♥ 1 : ♦ 2? : ♣ 0 : Total = 3?

The loser count looks a little messy - that's because of the circumstances. If you could have just played three rounds of ♠s you would probably have had 0 losers, and if you ruff this ♦ you will have only 2 ♦ losers, but maybe create a ♠ loser.

But though the loser count is confused your plan should not be. You **DO NOT** over-ruff the ♠10. Instead you discard your one ♥ loser (a loser-on-loser play). East can have this trick but whatever he returns you will win, pull trumps in **THREE** rounds if necessary, and take the rest of the tricks.

Discarding the ♥ loser instead of over-ruffing was the winning Plan. If you had over-ruffed you would have lost the ♥, but you would also have to lose a trump. You made a good play.

But did you notice that West made a bad play? He should have cashed his ♥A before he led the third ♦ for his partner to ruff. Then when his partner ruffed with the ♠10 your goose would have been cooked.

You have an easy 1♠ opening bid.

But West overcalls 2♦ and partner bids 3♦.

You should be certain to have a partnership agreement on the meaning of a cue-bid after an overcall.

Most good players use it to show support for opener's suit and at least 11 points. In other words, a hand with which you would have made a limit-raise or better.

So you bid the ♠ game.

South plays 4♠. West leads the ♦A, then ♦K, then ♦J. East discards on the second ♦ and ruffs the third one with the ♠10.